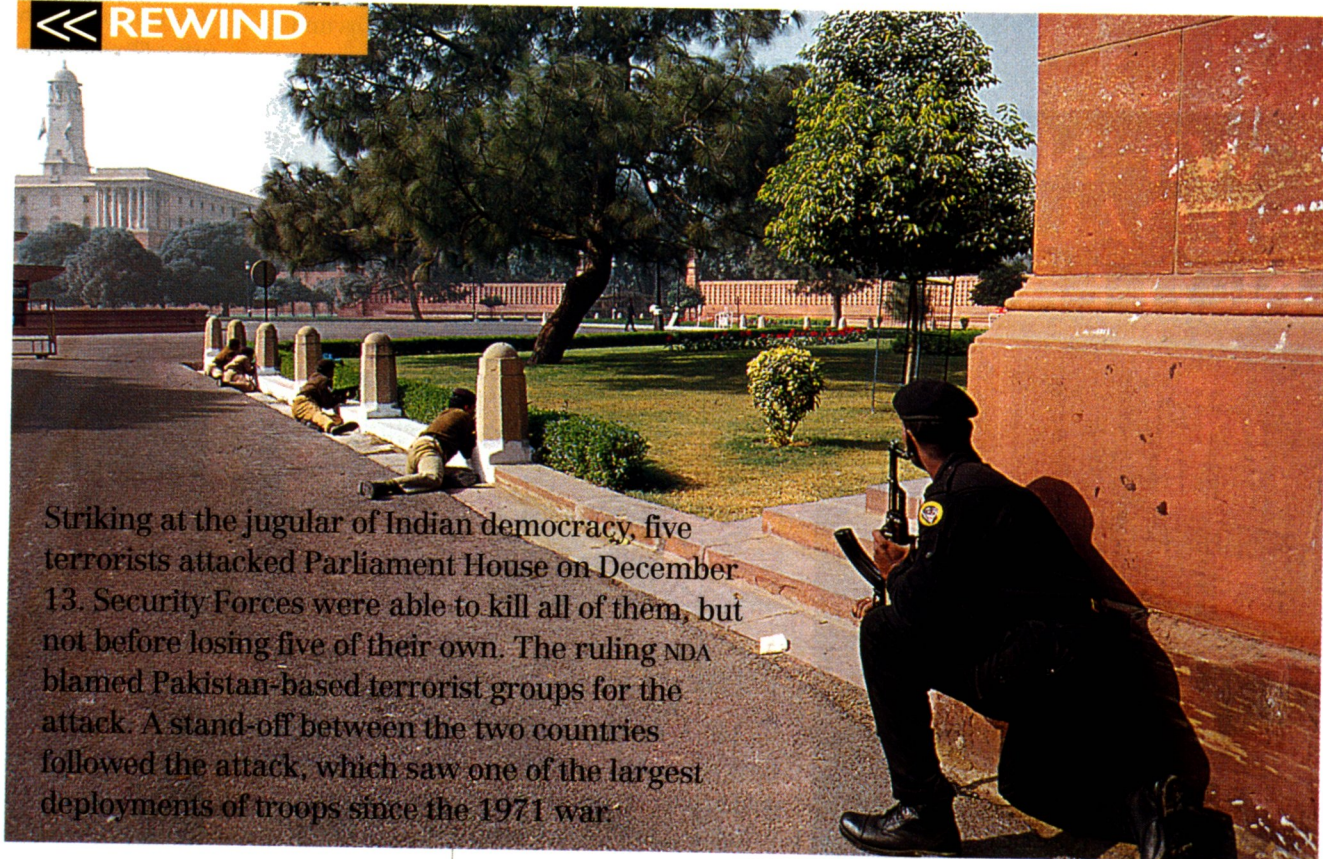


LINE OF FIRE

◀◀ REWIND



Striking at the jugular of Indian democracy, five terrorists attacked Parliament House on December 13. Security Forces were able to kill all of them, but not before losing five of their own. The ruling NDA blamed Pakistan-based terrorist groups for the attack. A stand-off between the two countries followed the attack, which saw one of the largest deployments of troops since the 1971 war.

BIG DEAL

A sting operation caught several politicians including BJP's Bangaru Laxman accepting bribes for alleged defence deals.



SHAILESH RAVAL

QUAKING DEATH

The Bhuj earthquake that struck on the morning of January 26, Republic Day, measured 7.6 on the Richter scale. One month after the tremblor, official figures placed the death toll at 19,727 and the number of injured at 166,000. Official estimates put the number of earthquake affected, directly or indirectly, at 15.9 million people out of a total population of 37.8 million.

FIRST CUT

• An eight-lane expressway between Delhi and Noida opened in January, the Noida Toll Bridge was the first infrastructure facility to be funded partly with money

raised from the capital market.

• Apple introduced iPod, a breakthrough MP3 music player that holds 1,000 CD-quality songs in an ultra-portable, 6.5 ounce design that fits in your pocket.

◀◀ DID YOU KNOW

That when Bandit Queen Phoolan Devi was shot dead by three armed men outside her home, she was about to lead a rebellion against Mulayam Singh Yadav in the Samajwadi Party.